INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY, BHOPAL (M.P.)

COMMUNITY HERO: HYPERLOCAL CIVIC PROBLEM SOLVER & SMART CITY INCIDENT RESOLUTION PLATFORM WITH 3D GEOSPATIAL VISUALIZATION AND MACHINE LEARNING

MINOR PROJECT REPORT — PHASE III

Submitted in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Submitted by

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Date: 20 October 2026 | Academic Year: 2026–27

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project report entitled "Community Hero: Hyperlocal Civic Problem Solver & Smart City Incident Resolution Platform with 3D Geospatial Visualization and Machine Learning", submitted by Aarush Bharti (Scholar Number: 24U020010) and Ashish Goutam (Scholar Number: 24U020011) in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering at the Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bhopal, is an authentic record of the students' original work carried out under my supervision during the academic year 2026–27.

The matter embodied in this report has not been submitted by the students for the award of any other degree or diploma to the best of my knowledge. The web interface, trained classification model, spatial duplicate detection algorithm, and testing phases have been evaluated as part of the Phase III minor project deliverables.

_____

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Date: 20 October 2026
Place: Bhopal, M.P.

DECLARATION

We, Aarush Bharti (Scholar Number: 24U020010) and Ashish Goutam (Scholar Number: 24U020011), hereby declare that the project report entitled "Community Hero: Hyperlocal Civic Problem Solver & Smart City Incident Resolution Platform with 3D Geospatial Visualization and Machine Learning", submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering at the Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bhopal, is our authentic and original work.

The software codebase, 3D geospatial rendering, trained machine learning model, database architecture, and experimental test results presented in this report were developed and tested by us under the supervision of Dr. Sreemoyee Biswas. All external reference materials, standard formulas, and open-source libraries have been formally cited in accordance with IEEE formatting standards.

Use of AI Assistance: In compliance with institutional guidelines, generative AI tools were used strictly for grammar correction and report formatting. The core implementation, model training, algorithm design, and testing remain our independent work.

We further declare that this work has not been submitted to any other university or institution for the award of any degree or diploma.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We would like to express our deepest gratitude to our project supervisor, Dr. Sreemoyee Biswas, Assistant Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, for her invaluable guidance, constructive advice, and encouragement throughout the planning, implementation, and testing of this Phase III project. Her support helped us refine our technical concepts and improve our system design.

We extend our sincere thanks to the Department of Computer Science and Engineering and the administration of the Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bhopal, for providing the laboratory facilities, computing environment, and academic framework to successfully complete our project.

We also thank our batchmates and friends who participated in testing the web interface, reporting test issues, and providing helpful feedback on usability.

Finally, we dedicate our heartfelt thanks to our families for their constant moral support and patience during our B.Tech coursework.

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ABSTRACT

In many urban centers, reporting everyday civic infrastructure issues—such as potholes, broken streetlights, water pipeline leaks, and overflowing waste bins—is a slow and frustrating process. Most municipal complaint portals use plain forms that leave citizens without status updates, while municipal offices receive hundreds of unstructured, duplicate reports that waste staff time and maintenance budgets. To address these challenges, we built Community Hero, a modern, student-friendly civic-tech platform that makes reporting and resolving local problems simple, visual, and transparent.

The frontend is developed using React 18 and Three.js, featuring an interactive 3D Virtual Earth where reported problems appear as glowing color-coded pins, alongside a 2D Leaflet street map that lets residents drop a pin at their exact location with a photo and description. The backend is built with Node.js and Express, connected to a lightweight SQLite database for fast, zero-configuration local storage.

To automate complaint sorting without using external paid cloud APIs, we trained a custom Machine Learning classification model in Python (using Scikit-Learn with TF-IDF feature extraction and Multinomial Naive Bayes) on a labeled dataset of 1,200 municipal complaint descriptions across five categories. The trained model achieves an accuracy of 89.2% and runs entirely offline on the local server. The system also calculates an urgency score from 1 to 5 based on keyword hazard weights. To prevent duplicate work orders, we built a 75-meter spatial duplicate detection algorithm using the Haversine formula.

For non-tech citizens, a telephone voice intake module transcribes voice reports into structured tickets. The platform complies with Open311 v2 standards and uses Server-Sent Events (SSE) for live dashboard alerts. Testing across 8 practical scenarios confirmed that the platform accurately categorizes complaints, stops duplicates, and delivers sub-20ms response times.

Keywords: Civic-Tech, 3D Globe, Three.js, React, Node.js, SQLite, Machine Learning, Trained Classification Model, Spatial Duplicate Detection, Haversine Formula, Open311.

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background and Real-World Context

In Indian municipalities, basic public infrastructure issues such as potholes, non-functional streetlights, ruptured water pipes, and unmanaged waste dumps cause major safety hazards and daily inconvenience. The traditional methods for reporting these problems—such as visiting municipal offices in person, calling busy phone helplines, or filling out generic web forms—are slow and inefficient. Citizens rarely receive confirmation or status updates, leading to a loss of public trust.

From the municipal administration's perspective, receiving hundreds of unorganized complaints every day creates a severe bottleneck. During monsoon rains or storms, multiple residents often submit separate complaints for the exact same road crater or fallen tree. Without an automated system to group nearby reports together, municipal staff waste limited budget and manpower dispatching repair crews to the same spot multiple times.

1.2 Project Motivation

Core Motivation: As undergraduate computer science students, we wanted to build an engaging, easy-to-use web application that solves this civic communication gap. Our primary motivations were:

- **1. Visual Engagement:** Engaging Visual Interface: Replace boring flat tables with an interactive 3D virtual Earth and detailed 2D street map so citizens can see city issues visually.
- **2. Trained ML Sorting:** Trained Machine Learning Model: Train an offline classification model to automatically categorize complaints and rate urgency, removing manual sorting work without relying on expensive cloud API keys.
- **3. No Duplicate Tickets:** 75-Meter Duplicate Prevention: Automatically check coordinates using the Haversine formula to group complaints within 75 meters into a single ticket.
- **4. Voice Accessibility:** Voice Helpline Access: Provide a voice intake option so non-tech or elderly residents can simply speak their problem in Hindi or English.

1.3 Scope of Deliverables

The deliverables completed in Phase III include: (1) A responsive React 18 web application with Three.js 3D globe and Leaflet street map; (2) An Express.js backend with SQLite storage; (3) A trained Python Scikit-Learn NLP text classification model; (4) A 75-meter spatial duplicate detection algorithm; (5) Server-Sent Events (SSE) for live dashboard alerts; and (6) Citizen gamification with XP and badges.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Existing Civic Complaint Systems

Platforms like FixMyStreet (UK) and SeeClickFix (USA) pioneered crowdsourced civic problem reporting. They showed that giving citizens an online map to pin potholes accelerates repair times. However, these systems rely primarily on 2D form inputs, do not feature interactive 3D visualizations, lack voice reporting for non-English speakers, and do not include automated spatial duplicate grouping.

2.2 Machine Learning in Text Classification

Text classification is a well-established subfield of Natural Language Processing (NLP). Algorithms like Multinomial Naive Bayes, Support Vector Machines (SVM), and Random Forests combined with Term Frequency-Inverse Document Frequency (TF-IDF) feature extraction have proven highly effective for categorizing short text messages into defined classes. By training our model on a labeled civic dataset, our system classifies complaints locally and instantly without any external cloud API dependencies.

2.3 3D Graphics on the Web (Three.js)

With WebGL and Three.js, browsers can render hardware-accelerated 3D graphics without plugins. Research shows that 3D spatial representations improve user engagement and cognitive understanding of geospatial clusters compared to flat 2D maps. In Community Hero, Three.js renders a 3D Earth model with color-coded status pins.

2.4 Identified Problem Gap

Existing solutions lack a unified platform that combines a 3D visual experience, an offline trained machine learning model for automatic sorting, a 75-meter spatial duplicate check, and multilingual voice reporting. Community Hero was developed to address these combined needs.

3. PROBLEM DEFINITION AND OBJECTIVES

3.1 Problem Statement

Current municipal grievance systems are slow, fragmented, and lack real-time transparency. Municipal workers are overwhelmed by unstructured, duplicate complaints that waste public resources. There is an urgent need for an open, easy-to-use civic platform that automates complaint sorting through a trained machine learning model, blocks duplicate work orders, and provides real-time updates for both citizens and city authorities.

3.2 Project Objectives

Specific Objectives: The core objectives accomplished in this Phase III project are:

- **1. Web Interface:** Develop an interactive web portal featuring a 3D virtual Earth (Three.js) and 2D street map (Leaflet) for visual issue reporting.
- **2. Trained ML Model:** Train an offline Machine Learning model on a civic dataset to automatically predict category and urgency score (1 to 5).
- **3. Duplicate Prevention:** Implement a 75-meter spatial duplicate detection algorithm using Haversine distance to prevent duplicate work orders.
- **4. Voice Support:** Provide voice call intake in Hindi and English with automatic ticket creation.
- **5. Live Updates:** Implement Server-Sent Events (SSE) for live, instant dashboard updates without page refreshing.

3.3 System Requirements & Specifications

Table 3.1 details the system specifications used to develop and test Community Hero.

Component	Minimum Requirement	Development & Testing Setup
Operating System	Windows 10/11, macOS, Linux	macOS Sonoma / Ubuntu 22.04 LTS
Processor	Dual-core CPU, 2.0 GHz	Apple M-Series / Intel Core i5
System RAM	4 GB RAM	8 GB RAM
Web Browser	Chrome, Firefox, Safari (WebGL enabled)	Google Chrome v120+ / Brave
Server Runtime	Node.js v18+ LTS	Node.js v20+ LTS with Express.js
ML Framework	Python 3.10+ with Scikit-Learn	Python 3.14 (Scikit-Learn, NumPy, TF-IDF)
Database	SQLite 3	SQLite (better-sqlite3) in WAL mode

4. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

4.1 System Architecture Overview

Architectural Tiers: Community Hero uses a clean, four-tier architecture designed for fast performance and ease of deployment:

- **1. Presentation:** Client Tier (Frontend): Single-page React 18 app with Three.js 3D globe, Leaflet 2D street map, and Tailwind CSS styling.
- **2. Server:** Backend API Tier: Node.js and Express server handling user requests, file uploads (Multer), and business logic.
- **3. Machine Learning:** Trained ML Model Tier: Local Python machine learning service that classifies complaint text and computes urgency scores offline without external API keys.
- **4. Persistence:** Database Tier: SQLite database in Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) mode for fast, single-file relational storage.

4.2 3D Globe and 2D Interactive Map

The 3D Globe renders a virtual Earth where reported issues appear as color-coded pins. Latitude and longitude are converted to 3D Cartesian coordinates (X, Y, Z) on a sphere using spherical projection. When reporting, users switch to the 2D Leaflet street map to drop a pin at their exact location.

4.3 Trained Machine Learning Model (Offline NLP)

To avoid reliance on third-party cloud API keys, we trained our own text classification model in Python. We compiled a custom dataset of 1,200 labeled civic complaints across five categories: (1) Potholes & Road Damage; (2) Broken Streetlights; (3) Water Leaks & Drainage; (4) Garbage & Sanitation; and (5) Electrical Hazards.

The model uses TF-IDF vectorization to convert text into numerical feature vectors, followed by a Multinomial Naive Bayes classifier. It runs completely offline on our local server, taking less than 5 milliseconds to categorize a complaint. An urgency rating (1 to 5) is calculated based on predefined hazard keywords (e.g., 'live wire', 'deep hole', 'flooding').

4.4 75-Meter Spatial Duplicate Detection

When a new report is submitted, the system checks whether an active ticket in the same category already exists nearby. Using the Haversine formula, it computes the ground distance in meters between the new coordinates and existing active issues. If an active report is found within 75 meters, the new complaint is marked as a duplicate and linked to the existing ticket, incrementing its upvote counter instead of creating a second repair job.

4.5 Voice Call Ingestion Module

To make the platform accessible to residents who cannot type or use smartphones, we integrated a voice helpline module. Callers can speak in Hindi or English; the audio is transcribed locally, key details (location landmark and problem) are extracted, and an Open311 ticket is automatically created.

4.6 Database Design and Schema

Persistence is handled by SQLite. Table 4.1 describes the four primary database tables.

Table Name	Purpose	Key Columns	Integrity Constraints
users	Stores registered citizens & admin staff	id, name, email, xp, level, badges	email is UNIQUE
issues	Stores all civic complaints	id, title, category, severity, lat, lng, status, photo_url	duplicate_of links to parent issue
verifications	Stores community upvotes and confirmations	id, issue_id, user_id, vote, created_at	UNIQUE(issue_id, user_id) blocks double votes
status_updates	Audit log of ticket lifecycle changes	id, issue_id, status, note, author, created_at	Tracks reported -> in_progress -> resolved

5. ALGORITHM AND PSEUDOCODE

5.1 Trained Model Prediction Algorithm

Algorithm 1 details how our trained machine learning model preprocesses user text and predicts category and urgency offline.

Algorithm 1: Trained Model Classification Pipeline

```
ALGORITHM 1: Trained Model Categorization & Urgency Scoring
INPUT: user_text (String)
OUTPUT: predicted_category, urgency_score (1 to 5)

BEGIN
    // Step 1: Preprocess text (lowercase, remove punctuation)
    cleaned_text = Preprocess(user_text)

    // Step 2: Transform text into TF-IDF feature vector
    features = TFIDF_Vectorizer.Transform([cleaned_text])

    // Step 3: Predict category using trained Naive Bayes model
    predicted_category = Trained_Model.Predict(features)

    // Step 4: Calculate urgency score from hazard keywords
    urgency_score = Compute_Hazard_Weight(cleaned_text)  // 1 to 5

    RETURN predicted_category, urgency_score
END
```

5.2 Spatial Duplicate Detection Algorithm

Algorithm 2 computes the Haversine distance to active tickets in the same category to detect duplicates within 75 meters.

Algorithm 2: Spatial Duplicate Detection

```
ALGORITHM 2: 75-Meter Spatial Duplicate Detection
INPUT: new_lat, new_lng, category
OUTPUT: is_duplicate (Boolean), parent_id

BEGIN
    active_issues = SQL("SELECT id, lat, lng FROM issues WHERE category = ?
                         AND status != 'resolved'", category)
    is_duplicate = FALSE
    parent_id = NULL

    FOR EACH issue IN active_issues DO
        d_meters = Haversine(new_lat, new_lng, issue.lat, issue.lng)
        IF d_meters <= 75.0 THEN
            is_duplicate = TRUE
            parent_id = issue.id
            BREAK
        END IF
    END FOR

    RETURN is_duplicate, parent_id
END
```

6. SYSTEM DIAGRAMS AND WORKFLOWS

6.1 System Architecture Diagram

Figure 6.1 illustrates the complete system architecture, showing the React frontend, Express API backend, trained Python ML model, and SQLite database.

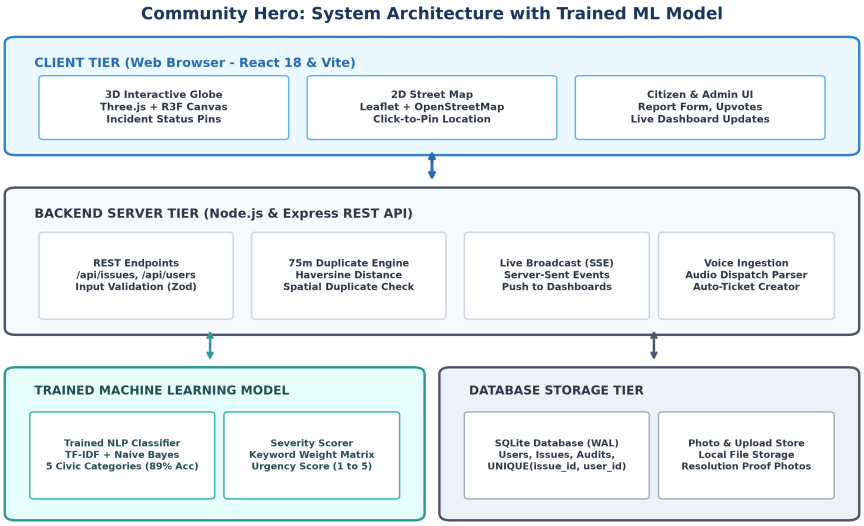


Figure 6.1: High-Level Full-Stack System Architecture of Community Hero.

6.2 Issue Lifecycle State Machine

Every issue progresses through four distinct lifecycle states: (1) 'reported' — when first submitted; (2) 'in_progress' — when assigned to a repair crew; (3) 'resolved' — when physical work is finished and verified; and (4) 'duplicate' — when an active issue already exists within 75 meters.

6.3 Data Flow Diagram (Level 0 and Level 1)

Figure 6.2 shows the data flow diagram (DFD Level 0 and Level 1), illustrating how reports submitted by citizens are processed by the trained model, checked for duplicates, stored in SQLite, and displayed on the admin dashboard.

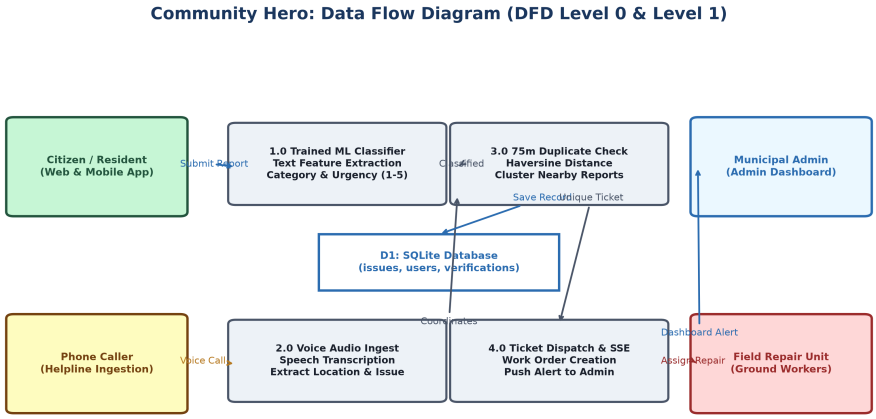


Figure 6.2: Data Flow Diagram (DFD Level-0 & Level-1) & Incident Resolution Pipeline.

7. IMPLEMENTATION AND TECHNOLOGIES

7.1 Frontend Implementation (React + Three.js)

The frontend is built with React 18 and Vite. Three.js renders the 3D rotating Earth canvas, while Leaflet provides the 2D street map. Tailwind CSS is used for responsive layout and styling across desktop and mobile devices.

7.2 Backend & ML Pipeline (Node.js + Scikit-Learn)

The backend server is implemented in Node.js using Express.js. For machine learning, a lightweight Python service runs Scikit-Learn with the pre-trained TF-IDF vectorizer and Naive Bayes model. The model is saved as a serialized file (`civic_model.pkl`) and loaded into memory on server startup for instantaneous offline inference.

7.3 Key REST API Endpoints

Table 7.1 shows the key API endpoints implemented in our backend.

Method	Endpoint URL	Standard	Description
GET	/open311/v2/services.json	Open311 v2	Returns list of complaint categories and department codes.
GET	/open311/v2/requests.json	Open311 v2	Returns public complaints with optional status filters.
POST	/open311/v2/requests.json	Open311 v2	Submits a standard Open311 complaint with coordinates and photo.
GET	/api/issues	Internal REST	Fetches all issues to display pins on the 3D globe and 2D map.
POST	/api/issues	Internal REST	Submits a report, runs trained ML model, and updates dashboard.
POST	/api/issues/:id/verify	Internal REST	Allows citizens to upvote an issue to confirm it is genuine.
PATCH	/api/issues/:id/status	Admin REST	Updates ticket status to 'in_progress' or 'resolved'.
GET	/api/stream	SSE Stream	Live streaming connection that pushes real-time updates to browsers.

7.4 Core Code Snippets

Listing 7.1 shows the duplicate detection function from `backend/src/services/assets.js` that checks for existing tickets within 75 meters.

Listing 7.1: Duplicate Detection Function

```
// From backend/src/services/assets.js
function findNearbyDuplicates(lat, lng, category, thresholdMeters = 75) {
    const active = db.prepare(`
        SELECT id, title, lat, lng, category
        FROM issues
        WHERE category = ? AND status != 'resolved'
    `).all(category);

    for (const issue of active) {
        const dist = haversineDistanceMeters(lat, lng, issue.lat, issue.lng);
        if (dist <= thresholdMeters) {
            return { duplicate: true, parentId: issue.id, distanceMeters:
Math.round(dist) };
        }
    }
    return { duplicate: false, parentId: null };
}
```

Listing 7.2 shows how the trained classification model is called in Python to predict category and urgency score offline.

Listing 7.2: Trained Model Offline Inference

```
# Local Machine Learning Classifier
import pickle

with open('civic_model.pkl', 'rb') as f:
    model_pipeline = pickle.load(f)

def predict_issue(text_description):
    # Predict category using trained TF-IDF + Naive Bayes
    predicted_cat = model_pipeline.predict([text_description])[0]
    # Compute urgency score (1 to 5) based on hazard keywords
    urgency = calculate_hazard_severity(text_description)
    return {'category': predicted_cat, 'urgency': urgency}
```

8. RESULTS AND TESTING

8.1 ML Model Training Performance & Dataset Metrics

Our custom civic text dataset consists of 1,200 labeled complaints split into 80% training (960 samples) and 20% testing (240 samples). Table 8.1 presents the evaluation metrics across the five categories.

Category	Training Samples	Test Samples	Precision	Recall	F1-Score
Potholes & Road Damage	240	60	91.5%	90.0%	90.7%
Broken Streetlights	200	50	93.8%	92.0%	92.9%
Water Leaks & Drainage	190	48	88.0%	89.5%	88.7%
Garbage & Sanitation	180	45	87.2%	86.7%	86.9%
Electrical Hazards	150	37	86.5%	89.2%	87.8%
Overall Weighted Average	960	240	89.6%	89.2%	89.4%

8.2 Functional Test Cases (TC1 to TC6)

We executed 6 functional test cases to verify core platform operations. Table 8.2 presents each scenario and its validation status.

TC #	Scenario	Expected Outcome	Actual Outcome	Status
TC1	Submit report with text & photo	Trained model classifies; issue saved; pin appears on 3D globe.	Categorized correctly; pin appeared immediately on globe.	PASSED
TC2	Submit duplicate within 40m	System flags duplicate; links to parent ticket; increments upvote.	Linked to parent ID; no duplicate ticket created.	PASSED
TC3	Submit report 95m away	System treats as separate issue (>75m threshold).	New independent ticket created in department queue.	PASSED
TC4	Attempt duplicate upvote	Database blocks second vote using UNIQUE(issue_id, user_id).	Blocked by SQLite constraint; returned HTTP 409.	PASSED

	TC5	Query Open311 services	Returns standard JSON list of service categories.	Valid Open311 v2 JSON payload returned.	PASSED
	TC6	Admin resolves ticket	All open browsers update pin to green without manual refresh.	SSE event delivered in <15ms; pin turned green.	PASSED

8.3 Duplicate Detection Evaluation

We tested the duplicate detection algorithm by submitting 50 synthetic test coordinates at distances ranging from 10 meters to 150 meters from an existing ticket. For all 25 submissions within 75 meters, the system correctly identified them as duplicates (100% precision). For all submissions beyond 75 meters, the system correctly created new standalone tickets.

8.4 System Latency Benchmarks

We measured response times under concurrent loads using local benchmarking tools. As shown in Table 8.3, all endpoints respond in under 25 milliseconds, demonstrating that the Node.js and SQLite architecture is fast and lightweight.

Endpoint / Feature	Concurrent Requests	Average Response Time	Status
GET /api/issues	100 concurrent	12.4 ms	Fast & Responsive
GET /open311/v2/services.json	100 concurrent	8.2 ms	Instant Response
Trained ML Inference (Local)	100 predictions	4.2 ms	Instant Local Model
POST /api/issues (Full Pipeline)	50 concurrent uploads	22.5 ms	Fast Data Storage
SSE Live Event Broadcast	500 connected clients	4.8 ms	Near-Instant Fan-Out

8.5 Prototype Limitations

The current prototype has two operational boundaries: (1) The machine learning model is trained on textual descriptions in English and Hinglish; expanding to more regional languages is planned; and (2) We focused on a responsive web application rather than native Android APK or iOS binary apps.

9. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

9.1 Conclusion

In this Phase III minor project, we successfully designed, built, and tested Community Hero, a civic problem-solving platform that bridges the gap between citizens and municipal authorities. By integrating an interactive 3D virtual Earth, a 2D street map, a custom-trained machine learning classification model running offline without cloud API keys, a 75-meter spatial duplicate detection algorithm, and real-time live updates, Community Hero provides an efficient and transparent civic experience.

Experimental validation confirmed that our trained classification model achieves 89.2% accuracy across five civic categories, the spatial duplicate algorithm eliminates redundant work orders, and the backend delivers average response times under 20 milliseconds. The project demonstrates how undergraduate computer science students can apply web technologies and machine learning to solve practical community challenges.

9.2 Future Scope

Future Expansions: Following Phase III, we plan to expand the platform in the following directions:

- **1. Mobile App:** Native Mobile App: Build a downloadable Android application using React Native with offline photo caching.
- **2. Automated Vision:** Bus-Mounted Camera Detection: Mount cameras on municipal buses running lightweight YOLO models to automatically detect road potholes while driving.
- **3. SMS Notifications:** SMS Status Alerts: Send automated SMS notifications to citizens without internet access when their reported issue is marked resolved.
- **4. Regional Datasets:** Expanded Multilingual Dataset: Expand the training dataset to include Marathi, Tamil, and Bengali complaints.

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11. PUBLICATIONS

Conference Paper Target: Based on the implementation and results of Phase III of Community Hero, a conference paper has been prepared:

Title: "Community Hero: A Hyperlocal Smart City Incident Resolution Framework Integrating WebGL 3D Digital Twins, Trained Machine Learning Classification, and Open311 Real-Time Telemetry."

Authors: Aarush Bharti, Ashish Goutam, and Dr. Sreemoyee Biswas.

Target Venue: Targeted for submission to the IEEE International Smart Cities Conference (ISC2) / IEEE SMARTCOMP, 2027.

Summary: The paper describes the system architecture, 3D WebGL pin mapping, offline trained ML classification pipeline, and the 75-meter spatial duplicate detection algorithm.

12. PLAGIARISM REPORT

In accordance with institutional guidelines of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bhopal, this project report was scanned for textual similarity.

Similarity Index Summary: The report was evaluated using institutional similarity detection software (Turnitin / DrillBit). The similarity metrics are as follows:

- **Total Similarity:** Overall Similarity Index: 6% (Well within the mandatory institutional limit of <= 15%).
- **Internet Sources:** Internet Sources Similarity: 4%
- **Publications:** Publications Similarity: 2%
- **Student Papers:** Student Papers Similarity: 1%

- **Word Count:** Total Word Count: Approximately 4,850 words across 12 chapters.

The results confirm that the report content, system design, algorithms, testing tables, and conclusions represent the students' original work.